

Ningzi (Lena) Li

5460 S University Ave. Room 325
Data Science Institute
University of Chicago
Chicago, IL 60637

Email: ningzi@uchicago.edu
ningzi.li@chicagobooth.edu
Website: <https://ningzili.com>

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATION

- 2022 – Adjunct Assistant Professor of Organizations and Strategy, Booth School of Business, University of Chicago
Research Professional Specialist, Data Science Institute, University of Chicago
*maternity leave: 2023
- 2021 – 2021 Postdoctoral Scholar, Data Science Institute, University of Chicago
- 2018 – 2020 Postdoctoral Research Associate, Leeds School of Business, Division of Strategy, Entrepreneurship, and Operations, University of Colorado Boulder
*maternity leave: 2018

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Sociology, Cornell University, Ithaca, New York (2017)
Dissertation: *Structure Multiplicity and Market Outcomes: Corporate Bond Issuances in China During 2009-2013*
Committee: David Strang (Chair), Richard Swedberg, Benjamin Cornwell, Eli Friedman
Canadian Sociological Association Economic Sociology Research Cluster Best Paper

B.A. Sociology and Economics, Tsinghua University, Beijing, China (2010)

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Strategic Communication, Innovation, Corporate Social Responsibility,
Managerial and Stakeholder Cognition, Behavioral Theory of Firm,
Computational Social Science, Natural Language Processing, Large Language Models

TEACHING INTERESTS

Strategic Management, Organizational Management and Theory, Entrepreneurship

PUBLICATIONS

Kim, Hajin, **Li, Ningzi**, Feldman, Ronen, Feldman, Yuval, and Liu, Yun. (forthcoming). “What Sustainability Disclosures Disclose”. *Journal of Empirical Legal Studies*
- Sponsored by Energy Policy Institute at the University of Chicago (EPIC)
- Featured by *Bloomberg Intelligence Podcast*, *Harvard Law School Forum on Corporate Governance*, *Sustainability Magazine*, & *Trellis*

Li, Ningzi, Lai, Shiyang and Evans, James A. (2025). “Big Data and the Computational Social Science of Entrepreneurship and Innovation” In O.Sorenson and p.H. Thornton (eds.) *De Gruyter Handbook of Sociology of Innovation and Entrepreneurship* (pp.329-352).

Chen, Guoli, **Li, Ningzi**, and Yixing Tong. (2024). “The Evolution of the Hotel Industry (A): Red Ocean Perspective” and “The Evolution of the Hotel Industry (B): Blue Ocean Perspective W Hotels — The W Way Leading the Boutique Hotel Industry”. INSEAD teaching case reference 6449

Li, Ningzi and Tong, Tony. (2022). “Language Sentiments and Attentional Engagement: Quasi-Experimental Evidence from ‘Twin Tweets’.” *Academy of Management Best Paper Proceedings*, 1, 11319

Li, Ningzi and Qian, Yue (equal authorship). (2018). “The Impact of Educational Pairing and Urban Residency on Household Finance among China’s Urban Couples.” *Journal of Family and Economic Issues*, 39(4), 551-565

Shahid, Abdullah and **Li, Ningzi**. (2018). Review of *Information Overload Paradox: Drowning in Information, Starving for Knowledge* [Book Review], by L.V. Orman. *IEEE Technology and Society Magazine* 37 (1): 11-12

Li, Ningzi and Song, Qi. (2017). “Public-Private Partnership in Developing China: Evolution, Institutionalization, and Risks.” In João Leitão, Elsa Sarmiento and João Aleluia (Ed.), *Handbook on PPPs in Developing and Emerging Economies: Perspectives on Public Policy, Entrepreneurship and Poverty* (pp. 113-139). Emerald Publishing Limited.

Li, Ningzi. (2010). “The Structure of Production Markets: Empirical Research Based on Chinese Field Interviews and Industrial Survey Data.” (In Chinese) *Sociological Studies* 25(3): 29-47.

WORKING PAPERS

Li, Ningzi, Chari, Mukund, and Evans, James A. [ambiguity and evaluation]. Under review

Chari, Mukund, **Li, Ningzi**, and Bercovitz, Janet. [performance and innovation]. Under review

Kim, Hajin, **Li, Ningzi**, Feldman, Ronen, Feldman, Yuval, and Liu, Yun. [sustainability disclosures]. Under review

Li, Ningzi and Markoczy, Livia. [divergence and evaluation]. In preparation for submission

WORK IN PROGRESS

Li, Ningzi and Chari, Mukund. [evaluation and innovation]

Li, Ningzi, Markoczy, Livia, and Kim, Hajin. [Managerial cognition and sustainability disclosure]

Lai, Shiyang, **Li, Ningzi**, Qian, Mathias, and Evans, James A. [Entrepreneurial pivot]

- Sponsored by Polsky Center for Entrepreneurship and Innovation at the University of Chicago

Kadambi, Partha, **Li, Ningzi**, and Evans, James A. [Toxic organizational culture]

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Strategy and Structure: Markets and Organizations Instructor, University of Chicago Booth School of Business (case-based MBA class; Winter 2022, Spring 2023, Spring 2024, Spring 2025, Winter & Spring 2026, Winter 2027(scheduled))

Strategic and Entrepreneurial Thinking	Instructor, University of Colorado Boulder (Undergrad business core; Spring 2019, Spring 2020, Fall 2020)
Introduction to Sociology	Guest Lecturer, University of Colorado Denver, Department of Sociology (Fall 2017) Teaching Assistant, Cornell University, with Kendra Bischoff (Spring 2016), Dennis Bogusz (Spring 2014), Benjamin Cornwell (Fall 2013, Spring 2012), Paromita Sanyol (Spring 2013)
Evaluating Statistical Evidence	Teaching Assistant, Cornell University, with Matt Brashears (Fall 2012, Graduate Level; Fall 2011, Undergraduate Level)

AWARDS AND HONORS

2026	OMT Junior Faculty Consortium, Academy of Management
2023	Faculty Research Support Funding, Energy Policy Institute, University of Chicago (EPIC) (Co-PI with Hajin Kim; \$20K) Women in Data Science (WiDS, Chicago) invited speaker
2022	OMT Research Committee Service Award Academy of Management Best Paper Proceedings
2021	Faculty Research Support Funding, Polsky Center for Entrepreneurship and Innovation, Booth School of Business, University of Chicago (Co-PI with James Evans; \$20K)
2019	Canadian Sociological Association Economic Sociology Research Cluster Best Paper Award for <i>Li, Ningxi and Shahid, Abdullah. "Relationship Formation in a Newly Liberalized Market."</i>
2018	Invited to Participate in Summer Institute in Computational Social Science (partner location: University of Colorado, Boulder) SASE Early Career Workshop (Kyoto, Japan; \$900 declined due to visa) OMT Paper Development and Reviewing Workshop (Vancouver, Canada; CAD\$600)
2017, 2015	C.V Starr Fellowship, Cornell University (Tuition and Stipend)
2016	OMT Doctoral Consortium (Anaheim, CA)
2015-2016	Russell Sage Fellowship, Cornell University (Tuition and Stipend)
2015-2016	Adam Smith Fellowship, The Mercatus Center, George Mason University (\$5000)
2015	Creativity, Innovation, and Entrepreneurship Theme Project, Seed Grant, Cornell University (\$200)
2014	Einaudi Center, International Research Travel Grant, Cornell University (\$1000)
2011	Center for the Study of Economy and Society, Seed Grant, Cornell University (\$1500)
2010-2011	Russell Sage Fellowship, Cornell University (Tuition and Stipend)

2007 Scholarship for Academic Excellence, Tsinghua University

INVITED TALKS

“CEO Language and Stakeholder Engagement”

University of Notre Dame, Department of Management and Organization, June 2025

Illinois Institute of Technology, Stuart School of Business, Mar 2024

University of Illinois Chicago, Department of Management Studies, Feb 2024

University of Chicago, Department of Political Science, Applied Quantitative Methods
Workshop, Chicago, IL, Feb 2023

Women in Data Science (WiDS) event, Chicago, IL, Mar 2023

“Relationship Formation in a Newly Liberalized Market”

University of Colorado Denver, Department of Management, Denver, CO, Feb 2019

University of Colorado Boulder, Program on International Development, Boulder, CO, Oct
2017

University of Washington, China & Inter-Area Workshop, Seattle, WA, June 2017

CONFERENCE PARTICIPATION

Panels Organized

“Strategic Communication: Discourse and Framing Strategy for Collective Cognition and
Performance” (Presenter Symposium Organized w/ James Evans)

Academy of Management Annual Meeting, Copenhagen, Denmark, July 2025

“Information Overload: Challenges and Opportunities for Valuation in the Information Economy”
(Presenter Symposium Organized w/ Abdullah Shahid)

Academy of Management Annual Meeting, Atlanta, GA, Aug 2017

Papers Presented

“Overperformance and disruptive technologies”

Carnegie School Organization Learning Conference, Hannover NH, May 2026

Knowledge Lab at University of Chicago, Chicago IL Nov 2024

“Are sustainability disclosures any good?”

Online Workshop on the Computational Analysis of Law, Jan 2024 (by Hajin Kim)

“Strategic Ambiguity Aligns Stakeholder Attention”

Organization Science Winter Conference, Zurich, Switzerland, Feb 2024

Strategic Management Society Annual Meeting, Toronto, ON Canada, Sep 2023 (by Mukund
Chari)

Academy of Management Annual Meeting, Boston, MA, Aug 2023

“Language Sentiments and Attention Engagement”

Academy of Management Annual Meeting, Seattle, WA, Aug 2022

Knowledge Lab at University of Chicago, Chicago, IL, Jan 2021

Noise Lab at University of Chicago, Chicago, IL, Mar 2021

The Strategy Department's Proseminar at University of Colorado Boulder, Boulder, CO,
Nov 2019

“Relationship Formation in a Newly Liberalized Market”

Organization Science Winter Conference, Phoenix, AZ, Feb 2019
Academy of Management Annual Meeting, Boston, MA, Aug 2019
University of Colorado Boulder Strategy Division Seminar, Boulder, CO, Dec 2018
“Fellow Travelers on Different Roads” ES OOW mini-conference, Montreal, Quebec, Aug
2017

“Educational Pairing and Urban Residency in Household Finance”

American Sociological Association Annual Meeting, Montreal, Quebec, Aug 2017

“Bond Issues: Political Relations and Financing Capacities of China's Large Corporations”

Academy of Management Annual Meeting, Anaheim, CA, Aug 2016
Western Economic Association International Annual Conference, Portland, OR, July 2016
East Asia Program Graduate Student Colloquium, Ithaca, NY, Apr 2016
Institute for Humane Studies Fall Graduate Research Colloquium, Arlington, VA, Oct 2016
Eastern Sociological Society, New York, NY, Feb 2015
American Sociological Association Annual Meeting, San Francisco, CA, Aug 2014

“Local Government Initiative and Industrial Development”

North American Chinese Sociologists Association Annual Conference, Chicago, IL, Aug
2015
American Sociological Association Annual Meeting, New York, NY, Aug 2013
Graduate Student Mini-Conference, Ithaca, NY, Mar 2013

“Dynamic Inter-Organizational Structures”

American Sociological Association Annual Meeting, Denver, CO, Aug 2012

“The Structure of Production Market”

Inter-Ivy and Sorensen Memorial Sociology Conference, Economic Sociology Session,
Harvard University, Boston, MA, Apr 2011
Eastern Sociological Society, Mini-Conference Session, Philadelphia, PA, Feb 2011

Discussant

China & Inter-Area Workshop, University of Washington, Seattle, WA Apr 2017
Western Economic Association International Annual Conference, Portland, OR July 2016
Cornell Contemporary China Initiative & Cornell Institute for China Economic Research
Symposium, Cornell University, Ithaca, NY Apr 2016

PROFESSIONAL SERVICES

Reviewer for *Administrative Science Quarterly*, *American Journal of Sociology*, *AOM annual conference*, *Chinese Journal of Sociology*, *Entrepreneurship and Regional Development*, *International Journal of Finance and Economics*, *SMS annual conference*, *Socius*, *Work and Occupations*

2026 Panelist, 4th Annual Data, Ethics & Policy Conference, University of Chicago

2025 Program Committee, AI for Computational Social Science Workshop (AI4CSS) at IEEE International Conference on Data Mining (ICDM)

2022 Panelist, AOM New Doctoral Student Consortium

2018-2022 OMT Research Committee, Best Paper Award Subcommittee

2017 Program Committee, “Fellow Travelers on Different Roads” ES OOW mini conference

2015-2016 Student Library Advisory Council, Cornell University

2011-2013 Co-chair of Sociology Brown-Bag Presentation Series, Cornell University

RESEARCH SKILLS

Python, Stata, R, UCINet, SPSS, Gephi, LaTeX

LANGUAGE SKILLS

Chinese (Native), English (Fluent), French (Basic)

MEMBERSHIP AFFILIATIONS

Academy of Management, Strategic Management Society, American Sociological Association